Prove that each of the following languages is ***not*** regular using fooling sets.

1. $\left\{ 0^{2^n} \;\middle|\; n \geq 0 \right\}$

2. $\{0^{2n}1^n \mid n \geq 0\}$

3. $\{0^m 1^n \mid m \neq 2n\}$

4. Strings over $\{0, 1\}$ where the number of 0s is exactly twice the number of 1s.

5. Strings of properly nested parentheses `()`, brackets `[]`, and braces `{}`. For example, the string `([]){}` is in this language, but the string `([)]` is not, because the left and right delimiters don't match.

Harder problems to think about later:

6. Strings of the form $w_1\#w_2\#\cdots\#w_n$ for some $n \geq 2$, where each substring w_i is a string in $\{0, 1\}^*$, and some pair of substrings w_i and w_j are equal.

7. $\left\{ 0^{n^2} \;\middle|\; n \geq 0 \right\}$

*8. $\{w \in (0 + 1)^* \mid w$ is the binary representation of a perfect square$\}$

Solved problem:

9. Prove that the language $L = \{w \in (0+1)^* \mid \#(0,w) = \#(1,w)\}$ is ***not*** regular.

Solution (fooling set 0^*):

Consider the infinite set $F = \{0^n \mid n \geq 0\}$, or more simply $F = 0^*$.

We claim that every pair of distinct strings in F has a distinguishing suffix.

> Let x and y be arbitrary distinct strings in F.
> The definition of F implies $x = 0^i$ and $y = 0^j$ for some integers $i \neq j$.
> Let z be the string 1^i.
> Then $xz = 0^i 1^i \in L$.
> But $yz = 0^j 1^i \notin L$, because $i \neq j$.
> So z is a distinguishing suffix for x and y.

We conclude that F is a fooling set for L.

Because F is infinite, L cannot be regular. ■

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*This is **exactly** the proof from the lecture notes for the canonical non-regular language $\{0^n 1^n \mid n \geq 0\}$. The inner box is a proof that every pair of district strings in F has a distinguishing suffix.*

Solution (fooling set 0^*):

For any natural number n, let $x_n = 0^n$, and let $F = \{x_n \mid n \geq 0\} = 0^*$.

Let i and j be arbitrary distinct natural numbers.

Let z_{ij} be the string 1^i.

Then $x_i z_{ij} = 0^i 1^i \in L$.

But $x_j z_{ij} = 0^j 1^i \notin L$, because $i \neq j$.

So z_{ij} is a distinguishing suffix for x_i and x_j.

We conclude that F is a fooling set for L.

Because F is infinite, L cannot be regular. ■

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*This is another way of writing exactly the same proof that emphasizes the counter intuition; any algorithm that recognizes L **must** count 0s.*